



The Last Chapter Full of Laughter

Old Age Home Documentary — Pashupatinath, Kathmandu

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Digital Media Production |

Video link = <https://youtu.be/ClqAKOrUmu4>

Project Overview

Title

The Last Chapter Full of Laughter

Duration

6 minutes 30 seconds

Theme

Community, togetherness and joy

Type

Short Documentary Film

Location

Briddhashram Pashupati, Kathmandu

Language

Nepali interviews + English voiceover & subtitles

Concept and Research

Research Question

How can cinematography, editing, audio design, and visual storytelling emotionally connect audiences with the lives of elderly residents in a care home?

Why this concept?

- Elderly community rarely represented in Nepali media
- Briddhashram Pashupati symbolic location within Pashupatinath
- Focus on joy and community not hardship or pity

Pre-Production

Research

Studied 4 similar documentaries — Times of India, Nagarik TV, NTV Plus, Katha

Planning

Shot list, storyboard, Gantt chart — Weeks 1 to 17

Location Scout

Visited Pashupatinath area on 25 March 2026

Equipment

Sony A7V, ZV-E10II, A7CII, DJI Mic 3, two tripods

Permission

Obtained verbal permission from home manager on shoot day

Production

Shoot Day 1 — 31 March 2026

- Sony A7V + Sony ZV-E10II
- Staff interviews — Milan Tamang and caretaker
- Pashupatinath area B-roll footage

Shoot Day 2 — First week April 2026

- Sony A7V + Sony A7CII (full-frame upgrade)
- 6 elderly resident interviews
- Group Namaste shots — closing sequence
- Activity B-roll — eating, crafts, daily life

Key challenge: Building trust with elderly residents before interviews could begin

Post-Production

01

Edit in Premiere Pro 2026

Footage review, sync, assembly, voiceover, music, subtitles, lower thirds

02

Export to DaVinci Resolve

Single ProRes 422 HQ export — video only

03

Colour grade in DaVinci

S-Log3 to Rec.709 LUT — warm golden tone — camera matching

04

Final export from Premiere

H.264 — 4K 60fps — VBR 2 Pass — 50 Mbps — open captions burned in

Documentary Structure

0:00–0:25

Opening

Pashupatinath B-roll +
English voiceover
introduction

[Add screenshot here]

0:25–2:00

The workers

Milan Tamang and
caretaker interviews

[Add screenshot here]

2:00–5:30

Their voices

4 elderly resident
interviews with subtitles
and B-roll

[Add screenshot here]

5:30–6:30

Closing

Namaste shots + final
voiceover + fade to
black

[Add screenshot here]

Technical Highlights

4K S-Log3

Maximum dynamic range for colour grading flexibility

Dual camera

A7V primary + secondary camera — eliminates jump cuts

DJI Mic 3

Clean wireless audio for all interviews

Split workflow

Premiere Pro editing + DaVinci colour grading

Warm grade

S-Log3 LUT + golden tone + skin tone matching

Open captions

English subtitles burned in — always visible

Challenges and Solutions

Challenge

DaVinci Resolve lag on 4K footage

Residents unwilling to be interviewed

Three camera colour mismatch

Limited B-roll coverage

Solution

Split workflow — edit in Premiere, grade in DaVinci only

Waited patiently, no pressure — staff helped mediate

Individual grade per camera, A7V as reference

Reused clips contextually, applied slow motion

Reflection and Critical Analysis

What went well

- Documentary achieved its core theme
- Mongol Raj's laugh — most powerful moment
- Warm colour grade looks professional
- Voiceover and subtitles work effectively together
- Strong emotional connection with subjects

What I would improve

- Capture more B-roll per subject
- Use clapperboard for faster sync
- Record ambient sound separately
- Allow more time for post-production
- Second location scout before shoot

Thank You

The Last Chapter Full of Laughter

Questions welcome

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